

Ideation Methods

Exploring Possible Solutions for Blinkit

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1 Introduction

Ideation is a structured creative thinking process used to generate a wide range of ideas and solutions to a given problem. After understanding the domain and stakeholders, ideation helps develop meaningful improvements that address real challenges. This document applies multiple ideation methods to explore solution possibilities for quick-commerce services such as **Blinkit**.

2 Problem Context

Users of apps like Blinkit commonly report issues such as:

- Delayed deliveries during peak hours and evenings.
- Frequent “out of stock” or partial-fulfilment of orders.
- Inaccurate or incomplete delivery addresses.
- App instability, checkout failures, or payment gateway errors.
- Lack of clear communication about order status.
- Poor rider allocation and inefficient routing.

3 Ideation Methods Used

This section describes the ideation methods used and the ideas produced for Blinkit.

3.1 Brainstorming

Ideas generated:

- Address verification prompts before checkout.
- Real-time traffic and rider availability routing.
- Guaranteed delivery time windows.
- Smart order batching for nearby deliveries.
- Instant “Out of Stock” replacements.
- Restocking alerts for high-demand items.
- Lightweight PWA fallback for app failures.

3.2 SCAMPER

Substitute: Replace per-order delivery fee with subscription passes.

Combine: Combine groceries with instant meal add-ons.

Adapt: Use dynamic routing similar to ride-hailing apps.

Modify: Simplify checkout flow and auto-fill addresses.

Put to another use: Preposition stock using demand heatmaps.

Eliminate: Remove redundant confirmation screens.

Reverse: Allow users to reserve inventory for a short time.

3.3 Mind Mapping

Key idea clusters:

- Delivery experience
- Inventory accuracy
- User interface and journey
- Customer support
- Delivery partner workflow

3.4 5 Whys — Example

Problem: Evening deliveries are delayed.

1. High order volume.
2. Users place orders after work hours.
3. Packing and dispatch overloaded.
4. Limited staff and static routing.
5. No forecasting or adaptive routing.

Root Solution: Forecast demand, increase staffing, optimize routing, and create micro-stocks.

4 Consolidated Solution Directions

Smart Address Validation: Confirm block, floor, landmark, etc.

Demand-Based Staffing: Allocate staff according to predicted peak hours.

Improved Inventory Tracking: Real-time monitoring and smart replacements.

Streamlined Rider Workflow: Efficient routing and contact options.

Simplified Customer Support: Fast issue resolution and AI chat.

Resilience Systems: PWA fallback and retry mechanisms.

Subscription & Incentives: Loyalty passes and rider incentives.

5 Conclusion

Applying brainstorming, SCAMPER, mind mapping, and 5 Whys produced a range of actionable ideas for Blinkit. These solutions can improve delivery accuracy, customer satisfaction, app performance, and operational efficiency.